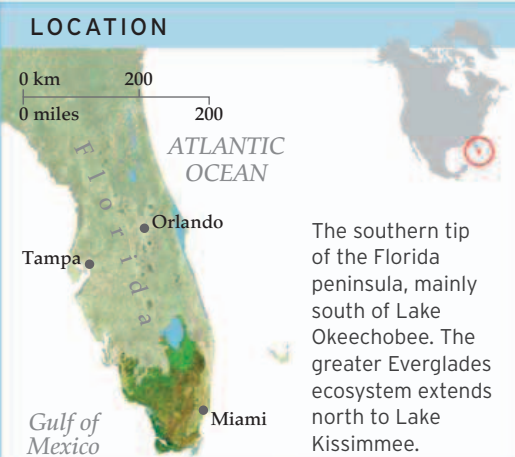


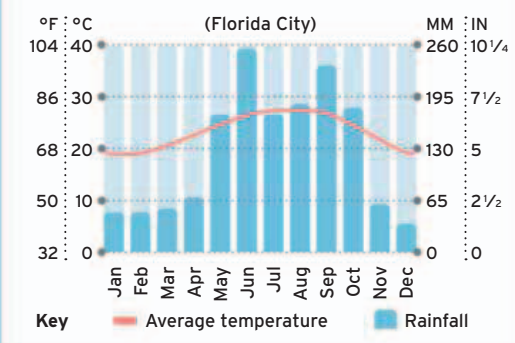
LOCATION



The southern tip of the Florida peninsula, mainly south of Lake Okeechobee. The greater Everglades ecosystem extends north to Lake Kissimmee.

CLIMATE

The Everglades are tropical, with two seasons: warm and dry from December to April, hot and wet from May to November.



Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Average temperature (°F)	68	72	78	82	86	88	86	82	78	72	68	65
Average temperature (°C)	20	22	26	28	30	31	30	28	26	22	20	18
Rainfall (mm)	130	140	150	160	180	195	200	190	170	140	120	110
Rainfall (in)	5.1	5.5	5.9	6.3	7.1	7.7	7.9	7.5	6.7	5.5	4.7	4.3

Key: — Average temperature ■ Rainfall

West Indian manatee

Trichechus manatus

With their bulgy bodies, broad heads, and wide, whiskery muzzles, West Indian manatees resemble walruses, but their closest living relatives are the elephant and the tiny, hooved, rodentlike hyrax. Gentle and slow-moving, manatees never haul out on land and cannot survive in cold conditions. They graze on salt- and freshwater plants, an activity that, along with their shape and docile nature, has earned them the nickname “sea cow”.

↔ 8–13 ft (2.4–3.9 m)

⚖ 440–1,320 lb (200–600 kg)

⊗ Vulnerable

🌿 Seagrasses, aquatic plants



SE. US to NE. South America, Caribbean



◁ **LANGUID PACE**
Manatees swim slowly, surfacing every three to five minutes to breathe. When resting, they can stay underwater for as long as 20 minutes.

Northern gray fox

Urocyon cinereoargenteus

Slight, quick, and agile, the gray fox is a capable climber, often resting as high as 59 ft (18 m) in trees out of reach of predators such as coyotes and dogs. Mainly nocturnal and a solitary hunter, it preys on rabbits and rodents in the winter, but its diet varies with the season and, like most foxes, it will eat almost anything it comes across. Both parents raise the pups, which are independent by fall.

↔ 22–26 in (56–66 cm)

⚖ 5–12 lb (2–5.4 kg)

⊗ Common

🐭 Rodents, birds, insects



North America to N. South America



◁ **BARKING CALL**
The gray fox has a wide range of vocalizations, including yapping barks, screams, and growls.



CYPRESSES

UNWELCOME INVADERS

A quarter of vertebrate species in the Everglades are introduced, posing a major threat to native wildlife. The huge Burmese python and so no natural predators and so its numbers are increasing. It is devastating local raccoon and rabbit populations.



BURMESE PYTHON

and crocodiles coexist